Meta Global AI Developer Hackathon: Master Guide & Winning Strategy

Strategic Playbook, Ecosystem Architecture & Execution Roadmap

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1. Hackathon Goal & Problem Statements

Your project must address one of the two official problem statements and incorporate Meta's AI models and tools:

- **Build for Your World:** Bring Meta's models into your domain. Solve a problem you know firsthand, free up time and mental space, and make something possible that wasn't before.
- **Push the Frontier:** Use Meta's models to tackle challenges in software, robotics, manufacturing, energy, materials, and beyond. Give a machine a new capability, accelerate a scientific experiment, or unlock a better way to understand and control a physical system. Show what becomes possible when these models meet the real world.

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2. Allowed Models, APIs & Technical Stack (STRICT)

You must incorporate Meta's models and strictly build around this core ecosystem:

A. Meta Model API Models

- **Muse Spark 1.3 (Muse Spark Series):** Trained for agentic workflows and optimized for competitive coding performance.
- **Muse Wonder:** Built for frontier coding, long-running agents, and advanced computer use to tackle demanding work.
- **Muse Image:** Agentic image generation, grounded by search and priced for production volume. Create and edit complex images in one model.
- **Muse Voice Transcribe:** Competitive transcription accuracy with live attribution for 20+ speakers ($0.18/hour on Meta Model API).

- **Segment Anything Model (SAM) 3.1:** Detect, segment, and track objects in images and video directly from a text prompt.

B. Meta Open-Weight Models

- **Muse Glimmer**
- **Muse Spark Open** *(Note: When using Baseten, use model ID* `meta-models/muse-spark-open-1026` *instead of* `meta-models/muse-spark-open`*)*

C. Developer Tooling

- **Muse Code:** Meta's coding agent to accelerate development.

D. Credits & Inference Partners

Partner Platform	Credit Allocation & Terms	Best For / Key Details
Meta Model API	$150 Credits (Claim by Wed, Nov 4 at 9:00 PM ET)	Primary API access. Requires credit card setup; set a Spend Limit notification.
Baseten	$100 Credits + 2M TPM Rate Limit (Up to 2,000 users)	Optimized for reasoning, vision, and audio for `meta-models/muse-spark-open-1026`.
Modal	$100 Credits (First 1,000 participants)	Serverless GPUs, custom Endpoints, sandboxes, and LLM fine-tuning tools.
Fireworks	$25 Team Credits (Select shortlisted teams)	Specialized intelligence, fast inference, and training with Muse Open Models.

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3. Rules, Restrictions & "Anti-Projects"

Core Rules & Submission Requirements

- **Open Source Requirement:** Your code repository **must be public**.
- **Team Size:** Solo participants or teams of up to **4 people maximum**.
- **One Submission Per Team/Startup:** Appoint one "Representative" to submit the project. Ensure all team members are listed on the submission page.
- **New Work Only:** Everything presented must be built during the Hackathon (**Oct 27 – Nov 4**). Startups may build on existing products/codebases, but **must clearly isolate and highlight** what was newly built during the event. Failure to clearly identify original hackathon contributions will result in **immediate disqualification**.
- **3-Minute Demo Video:** Required with your submission. Must only highlight the specific features, code, and functionality built during the Hackathon. Must be publicly accessible.
- **Banned Projects:** Immediate disqualification for violating legal, ethical, or platform policies, or using unauthorized code/data/assets.

Banned / "Anti-Projects" (Avoid These!)

Judges explicitly warn against generic hackathon tropes or policy-violating ideas:

- **Medical Advice:** AI Mental Health Advisors, skin blemish detectors, or anything generating medical advice.
- **Basic Wrappers:** Basic RAG applications, simple image analyzers, or simple "AI for Education" chatbots.
- **HR / Screening:** AI Job Application Screeners or Personality Analyzers.
- **Lifestyle / Coaching:** AI Nutrition Coaches, Sports analyzers, or sports coaches.
- **Sensitive Topics:** Anything political or involving war.

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4. Complete Schedule & Deadlines

*Note: Times listed in Eastern Time (ET). Subtract 1 hour for Central Time (CT).*OCTOBER 2024

Mon 26 [12:00 PM ET] Kickoff & Keynote Briefing

Tue 27 Building Period Begins | Workshop: Agents 101 (12:00 PM ET)

Wed 28 Workshop: Agents 102 (12:00 PM ET)

Fri 30 Workshop: Fireworks Open Models (12:00 PM ET)

NOVEMBER 2024

Tue 03 Final Technical Troubleshooting Day

Wed 04 [9:00 PM ET] FINAL SUBMISSION DEADLINE & API Credit Claim Cutoff

Thu 05 Judging Period Begins (Runs through Nov 8)

Sun 08 Most Viral Project (X Engagement) Tracking Ends

Mon 09 [12:00 PM ET] Closing Ceremony & Live Finals (Top 10 Teams)

Mon 16 Community Vote Winner Announced on Discord

Detailed Schedule Breakdown

Kickoff & Workshops

- **Mon, Oct 26 | 12:00 PM ET:** Opening remarks, overview, rules, prizes, judging, and Meta speaker kickoff.
- **Tue, Oct 27 | 12:00 PM – 1:00 PM ET:** *Agents 101: Build a Multimodal AI Agent* (Speaker: Suraj Subramanian)
- **Wed, Oct 28 | 12:00 PM – 1:00 PM ET:** *Agents 102: Best Practices for Verifiable Agents* (Speaker: Yash Khare)
- **Fri, Oct 30 | 12:00 PM – 1:00 PM ET:** *Building Specialized Intelligence on Fireworks: From Inference to Training with Muse Open Models* (Speaker: Sinan Ozdemir)

Support & Daily Office Hours

- **Weekdays (Oct 27 – Nov 4) | 10:00 AM – 11:00 AM ET:** Text-based Q&A with the Meta team in the `#office-hours` Discord channel.

Submission & Judging Deadlines

- **Tue, Nov 3:** Last full day for technical troubleshooting.
- **Wed, Nov 4 | 9:00 PM ET: FINAL DEADLINE** for project submissions via Cerebral Valley, final office hours, and API credit claims. Late submissions will not be considered.
- **Thu, Nov 5 – Sun, Nov 8:** Stage 1 & Stage 2 Judging Period. (Viral tracking ends Nov 8 EOD).

- **Mon, Nov 9 | 12:00 PM ET:** Closing Ceremony, Live Final Round (Top 10 teams), and winners announced.

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5. Judging Criteria & Prize Structure

Three-Stage Judging Process

1. **Stage One (Pass/Fail Viability):** Does the project reasonably fit the theme and meaningfully use the Meta Model API and/or Meta open-weight models?
2. **Stage Two (0–10 Scoring Rubric):**
    - **Impact (30%):** Real-world potential. Who benefits, and how much does it matter? Could people actually use this? Alignment with "Build for Your World" or "Push the Frontier."
    - **Use of Meta AI Tooling (25%):** Creativity of integration. Going beyond basic wrappers, model chaining, and unexpected capability surfaces.
    - **Demo (25%):** Working live product quality. Engaging, clear, and high-production 3-minute video presentation.
    - **Technical Depth & Execution (20%):** Sound engineering, verifiable workflows, and real architectural depth.
3. **Stage Three (Live Finals):** Top 5 scoring projects per track are reviewed live by final-round judges.

Key Technical Signals Meta Mentors Look For

- **Multimodal Agents:** Seamlessly combining vision/video (SAM 3.1, Muse Image), audio (Muse Voice Transcribe), and reasoning/action (Muse Spark 1.3 / Muse Wonder) into a single feedback loop.
- **Verifiable Agents:** Systems that verify their outputs, execute and check test cases, evaluate system states, and self-correct deterministically.
- **Specialized Open-Weight Inference:** Smart deployment of Muse Spark Open (`meta-models/muse-spark-open-1026`) or Muse Glimmer on infrastructure like Fireworks, Baseten, or Modal.

Prize Allocation ($1,000,000 Total Pool)

Track / Category	1st Place	2nd Place	3rd Place	4th Place	5th Place
Indie Developer Track	$150,000	$100,000	$75,000	$50,000	$25,000
Startups Track	$250,000	$150,000	$75,000	$50,000	$25,000

Special Bonus Categories ($50,000 Total)

- **Most Viral Project ($20,000):** Highest engagement (likes, reposts, comments) on X by Nov 8 EOD.
- **Best Build on Meta Open Weight Models ($10,000):** Premier implementation of Muse Glimmer or Muse Spark Open on custom hardware, Baseten, Modal, or Fireworks.
- **Community Vote ($10,000):** Highest vote tally in the public gallery by Nov 16.
- **Best Agentic Use-Case ($5,000):** Standout multi-step autonomous decision-making and workflow coordination.
- **Best Creative Build ($5,000):** Exceptional creative application utilizing Muse Image or Muse Wonder.

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6. High-Performing Project Archetypes & Strategic Recommendations

To maximize your score across Impact (30%), Meta AI Tooling (25%), Demo (25%), and Technical Depth (20%), target one of these proven architectural sweet spots:

Strategy 1: The "Full-Stack Meta Multimodal Pipeline"

(Designed for 25% Tooling + 25% Demo Score)

Chain 3 or more Meta models where each handles a dedicated pipeline stage:[Real-Time Video Feed] ──> (SAM 3.1 Object/Defect Tracking)



[Voice Input] ──────────> (Muse Voice Transcribe Attribution)



Strategy 2: Verifiable Computer-Use & Autonomous Engineering

(Designed for "Push the Frontier" & Agentic Excellence)

- **Core Focus:** Target complex domains like industrial legacy software, CAD suites, or robotic simulators.
- **Implementation:** Deploy **Muse Wonder** for operating desktop interfaces, coupled with **Muse Spark 1.3** to write runtime simulation code, and **SAM 3.1** to visually check the physical or simulated outcomes for state verification.

Strategy 3: Hybrid Frontier + Open-Weight Architecture

(Designed to qualify for the $10K Open-Weight Bonus)

- **Core Focus:** Optimized architectural routing balancing capability and speed.
- **Implementation:** Use **Muse Wonder** via the Meta Model API as the central high-level orchestrator. Route high-frequency, low-latency task execution or domain-specific verifications to **Muse Spark Open (`meta-models/muse-spark-open-1026`)** hosted on **Baseten**, **Modal**, or **Fireworks**.

Strategy 4: Visual-First Optimization for Virality & Demos

(Targeting the $20K Viral Bonus & 25% Demo Weight)

- **Core Focus:** Text-only terminal outputs fail to captivate social media feeds or demo judges.
- **Implementation:** Frame your demo around immediate visual impact. Highlighting real-time **SAM 3.1** video segmentation masks alongside active **Muse Wonder** computer-use cursor actions creates a compelling dynamic within the first 5 seconds of your video demo.